

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI

Founder & AI Solutions Consultant

Emeryville, CA

October 2023 - Present

- Ran discovery conversations with non-technical clients. Collected missing details, explained the options in plain language, and wrote clear next steps so they could decide with confidence.
- Kept several client threads moving at once over email and Slack in a fast-paced practice. Held a consistent professional tone and accurate notes on every thread.
- Owned intake through close-out on every engagement. Statements of work, forms, milestone tracking, and complete records for clients up to \$18K.
- Turned unwritten client processes into written procedures their staff could follow without a call.
- Trained an IT services team to run a new pre-sales workflow on their own. Processing time on their risk assessments fell 98%.
- Ran a solo practice, so every email, form, and follow-up was mine to complete accurately and on time.

Wiz Music

Community Development Intern

Barcelona, Spain

May 2022 - July 2022

- Ran Discord operations in English, Spanish, and Catalan, including an artist AMA against an engagement gap.
- Segmented churn and join sources, found that reported membership growth was not organic, and raised it with the team.

IBM, Customer Support

Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer

Austin, TX

August 2018 - December 2020

- Wrote release notes and product documentation that walked support stakeholders through application changes in plain language.
- Facilitated Design Thinking sessions to surface what support teams needed, then translated that into tools they could use.

Alpha Phi Delta, University of Colorado Boulder

Rush Chair

Boulder, CO

January 2019 - December 2021

- Owned the membership funnel: hosted rush events, built the recruitment profiles the chapter used, matched prospects to a fit, and converted them to signed bids.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

B.S. Information Science (Major GPA 3.7); Certificate of Cognitive Science

Boulder, CO

2018 - May 2023

- Senior capstone: built the backend for a camping-trip planner. It pulled campground, weather, and alert data and turned Leave No Trace practice into a game.
- Dean's List, Fall 2019 and Spring 2023. Technical communication, user-centered design, and cognitive science.

Certifications: Emergency Medical Technician (2024); AIARE 1 Avalanche Safety and Rescue (2022), including trip planning and group decision-making.

SKILLS

Communication: professional tone across email and Slack; client intake; explaining options in conversation and in writing.

Organization & accuracy: collecting missing information; forms; statements of work; milestone tracking; Microsoft Office; complete records.

Matching & discovery: asking questions, mapping needs, recommending a fit.

Travel & outdoors: live and work aboard a 1966 sailboat on the SF Bay; Barcelona internship; AIARE 1 trip planning; EMT; camping-trip planner capstone.

Languages: English (native), Spanish (conversational; two years of university coursework).

Tools: Microsoft Office, Slack, Notion. Quick to ramp on new systems.